

The HD Arms Race

Broadcom's Crystal HD and NVidia's Ion are fighting head to head to dominate the Netbook HD market, and Intel prefers Broadcom

#Business

Finally, a Business model for Twitter has emerged with enterprise accounts and adverts. Not that they need it right now, post the Google and Microsoft Search deals

Bad news for grandma

Mobile numbers may soon have 11 digits

If a proposal by DoT goes through, we may all see an additional digit added to our mobile numbers.

While India wasn't expected to reach the 500 million subscriber-mark till 2030, it seems to have beat that deadline by a good 21 years.

As is obvious, a ten digit numbering scheme can support only a limited number of phone number combinations, and while a plan was in place to have the transition by 2030, it seems that we are bound to run short much sooner than that.

The proposal would have all current cell phone numbers appended with a '9', instantly granting the country ten times as many phone numbers, and hopefully solving the problem for another few decades, or till foetuses decide to have their own dual-SIM mobile phones, whichever is sooner.

While 500 million subscribers are active, as many as 800 million might have already been used up, as people often change service providers and numbers, and operators often discontinue operating such numbers. Interestingly, it seems 20 per cent of allotted numbers are never even used.

While the DoT seems to be pushing to have this change ready by January 2010, operators claim they haven't received any intimation of the same, and are only aware of the long standing proposal. Additionally, they say this change will require extensive changes to their software and hardware, and is not some-

thing that can be done in such a short period. Why not get 20 digit phone numbers and save us the trouble for another couple centuries?

YouTube launches a Made for India feature

The internet is hurtling along at a fast pace moving from GIF animated images to full HD video. However, for us Indians, the wonders of the internet are still one long progress bar away.

new "Feather" experiment on their TestTube. TestTube for YouTube is the equivalent of the "Lab" features you find on GMail and allows you to participate in Google experimental features for their products.

The new "Feathers" experiment makes the YouTube interface much lighter, by putting focus on the most important thing people use YouTube for, the videos. With the "Feathers" experiment enabled, your videos

Acer launches new multi-touch, 3D products

On December 2, 2009, Acer launched a new range of products utilising some of the hottest concepts today - 3D and multitouch. Their new products include notebooks, projectors, and all-in-one PCs.

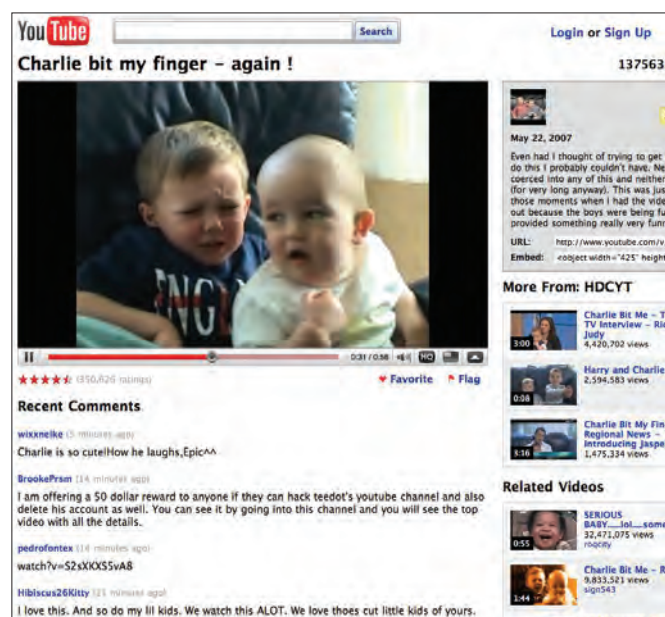
In their multi-touch segment is a new Acer Aspire 5738PzG series notebook which comes with a large 15.6-inch multi-touch screen, and comes with Windows 7 to make full use of the feature. The laptop is priced at Rs. 43,500 excluding taxes.

Another interesting product they have launched which used multi-touch, is their new Aspire 5600 series All-in-One (AIO) PCs. The AIO comes with a full 1080p HD enabled 23-inch multi-touch screen, with a powerful configuration: a Intel Core 2 Quad processor 2.33 GHz (Q8200), 4 GB of RAM, a 1 TB HDD, and a 512 MB graphics card.

The AIO PC will also come with an inbuilt DVD RW, and TV Tuner. Loaded with Window 7 Home Premium and a suite of Acer applications to help ease users into their new touch environment, the series is priced at a starting point of Rs. 60,000, excluding taxes.

Among their new 3D-enabled products is the new 5738D 3D Notebook, and the X1261 3D-ready projector.

The new notebook uses a combination of a special 3D "coating" on the screen, and polarised glasses to bring you



The new Feather feature in YouTube, especially for Indians

While YouTube happily launched 1080p HD video support, we've just started putting away our VCDs. Finland may have made 1 Mbps connections a legal right, but we have to pay through our nose for even half of that.

Google with the noble aim of shaving a few seconds of loading time, has now done us Indians a favour by adding a

will now default to standard quality, and the video page will only show a limited number of comments, and related features.

Good work Google! This will keep us busy till we get affordable 16 Mbps connections here too. Of course, by then, the world would've moved on to ultra high super duper resolution.